

Lincoln Local Plan 2023–2040

Chapter 5: Housing

Policy H1: Housing Supply

The Local Planning Authority will ensure the delivery of a minimum of 850 dwellings per annum over the plan period. Priority will be given to development on brownfield land within the existing built-up area of Lincoln. Windfall sites of 10 or more units will be acceptable in principle subject to compliance with other relevant policies in this plan, particularly regarding design, heritage, and flood risk.

Policy H3: Affordable Housing

On all residential development sites of 10 or more dwellings, or where the site has an area of 0.5 hectares or more, the Council will require a minimum of 30% of the total number of dwellings to be provided as affordable housing. The required tenure split for affordable housing is 70% social rent and 30% shared ownership. Where an applicant considers that the required level of affordable housing cannot be provided due to viability constraints, viability evidence must be submitted and will be subject to independent assessment at the applicant's expense.

Chapter 7: Design and Built Environment

Policy D1: Design Quality

All new development must achieve high-quality design and contribute positively to local character. Development proposals must demonstrate compliance with the Lincoln Design Guide. Commercial developments must achieve a minimum BREEAM rating of 'Very Good'. In city centre locations and along major movement corridors, ground floor commercial uses must provide active frontages to the street. Residential developments must provide minimum floor-to-ceiling heights of 2.5 metres for habitable rooms.

Policy D3: Heritage Assets

The City of Lincoln has a rich and unique historic environment. A Heritage Impact Assessment is mandatory for any development proposal that affects the setting of a listed building, or is located within or adjacent to a Conservation Area. Development proposals must demonstrate how they preserve or enhance the character, appearance, and setting of heritage assets. The NPPF tests for assessing substantial and less than substantial harm will be rigorously applied. Proposals causing substantial harm will be refused unless it can be demonstrated that the harm is necessary to achieve substantial public benefits.

Chapter 9: Natural Environment

Policy NE2: Flood Risk

Development proposals must comply with the Sequential Approach to flood risk. For any development proposed in Flood Zone 2 or Flood Zone 3, the Sequential Test must be applied and passed. For highly vulnerable or more vulnerable development in Flood Zone 2, the Exception Test is also required. Sustainable Drainage Systems (SuDS) are mandatory for all development sites above 0.1 hectares. Under no circumstances will highly vulnerable development be permitted in Flood Zone 3b (Functional Floodplain).